[Metric]
A-A-2756A
November 01, 1995
Superseding
A-A-2756
February 4, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE, FINE TIP
(FOR OVERHEAD PROJECTION TRANSPARENCIES)

This General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers tube type, fine tip markers for use in freehand marking, writing, and drawing on visual-aid transparencies.

2. Salient Characteristics:

2.1 The marker shall be a non-refillable type, designed to operate by capillary action. The marker shall be constructed to provide good protection against evaporation and leakage. The ink shall be water based, and held within the marker by an absorbent material so that there is no free liquid within the marker. Transparencies used in the testing of this marker shall be in conformance with A-A-2978 or equivalent.

2.2 The marker shall be equipped with a tight-fitting plastic or metal protective cap and the over-all length (with the cap in place) shall not be less than 130 mm (5.1 inches). The cap or body shall be colored, or have a colored marking to indicate the color of ink content.

2.3 Metal or plastic used shall be of a material appropriate for the intended purpose and when used externally shall be suitable for coating as a decorative finish.

2.4 The markers shall be furnished in the following colors; Black, Blue, Red, Green, Brown, Orange, Purple, and Yellow as specified in the contract or order.

2.5 The barrel shall be made of plastic or metal or a combination of these materials. The barrel diameter shall not be less than 7.8 mm (0.310 inches), excluding tapered and recessed ends, and not more than 12.7 mm (.5 inches) and shall be constructed so that the ink will emerge only through the writing nib.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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2.6 The writing nib may be of any material suitable for the intended purpose. The nib shall be permanently secured in position by an appropriate design feature and shall write a minimum distance of 610 m (2000 ft).

2.7 The manufacturer's name or trademark and item identification i.e. (audio visual marker **"AVM"** or overhead projection marker **"OPM"**) shall be exhibited on the marker. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

2.8 Shelf Life. The markers shall be able to meet all the requirements of this specification from the time of delivery to a minimum of 18 months under normal storage conditions. Suppliers shall replace, without cost to the government, all markers failing to meet this requirement.

2.9 Workmanship. The markers shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture which may affect their durability, appearance, serviceability or present a hazard to the user. The surface of the marker shall be of uniform appearance and shall be free from rough, sharp edges, or burrs, blisters, scratches and other defects.

3. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Examination and Testing.

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

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4.2.2 End item inspection / testing may be used by the offerer or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing they be used in determining visual and dimensional criteria.

4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one marker. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional testing shall be S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The inspection level for performance characteristics testing shall be S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

4.3 Performance Characteristic Tests: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 21°C ± 3° C (64.5°F - 75.2° F) and at a relative humidity of 50% ± 5% from the horizontal. Transparencies used in tests shall be of film material having a high polish finish, with a nominal thickness of .13 mm (.005 inch). The projector used shall be equipped with a six hundred (600) watt quartz bromide or equal. Test paper shall be in accordance with A-A-2804A, type III white bond paper having a pH of 5.0 and a basis weight of 60 grams per square meter (7.6 kg, 17 x 22 - 500). A tolerance of 5% is allowable. Alternately, paper conforming to JCP-O-60 can be used as an alternate source.

4.3.1 Drying Time & Fill. Place a transparency sheet smooth, flat surface and partially cover with a sheet of paper. Place a 115 gm weight (4 oz), approximately 31.75 mm (1.25 inches) in diameter, on top of the sheet of paper. Write a five-letter word on the exposed portion of the transparency, allow to dry 15 seconds, and immediately draw the paper and weight across the writing at a rate of approximately 101.6 mm (4 inches) per second. Neither the writing nor the paper drawn across the transparency shall show evidence of smearing or smudging. The markers reservoir shall be weighed with ink and then when empty. The fill shall weigh between 1.5 - 2 grams of ink to comply with the minimum write out distance.

4.3.2 Projectability. Write or print 4-5 words with marker on a transparency in conformance with commercial item description A-A-2958. Place the transparency on a projector as outlined in paragraph five (5) prepared and project the words on a white screen approximately 2.5 m (8.2 ft) away. The projected markings on the screen shall be sharp and clear when observed from a distance of 6 m (19.5 - 20 ft) and shall be of the same color identified as the markings on the transparency.

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4.3.3 Startability. Write a five-letter word with an unused sample marker on a transparency sheet as outlined in paragraph 4.3. Then place marker on its side with cap off for a minimum of fifteen and maximum of thirty minutes. Immediately draw the marker nib across a transparency at a rate of approximately 10.2 cm (4 inches) per second, in increments 20 cm (8 inches) until a solid continuous mark is attained. The marker shall produce a solid continuous mark not less than .38 mm (.015 inch) wide within four strokes.

5. Packaging:

5.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

6. Notes:

6.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2, Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

6.1.4 JCP Specifications may be obtained from Chief Paper Procurement Section, MMPP, US Government Printing Office, North Capital and H Street, NW, Washington DC 20401.

6.3 National Stock Number Listing.

Marker, Tube Type	Marker, Tube Type Assortment
7520-00-051-5031	7520-00-138-7981
7520-00-051-5033	7520-00-481-1964
7520-00-051-5035	
7520-00-051-5036	
7520-00-116-2886	
7520-00-116-2887	
7520-00-116-2888	
7520-00-116-2889	

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an interest in this commercial item description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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